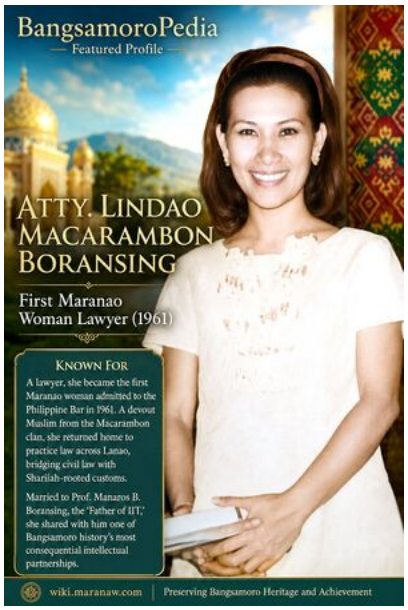
Lindao Macarambon Boransing

Atty. Lindao Macarambon Boransing (also written as **Bae Lindao Macarambon-Boransing**) was a Filipino lawyer from Iligan City, Lanao del Norte, and is historically recognized as the first Maranao woman to pass the Philippine Bar Examinations, having been admitted to the practice of law in **1961**. Her milestone came during a decade when very few Muslim women from Mindanao dared to pursue higher education beyond regional boundaries, let alone take on the national bar. She is also widely remembered as the life partner and steadfast support of Prof. Manaros B. Boransing, the founding Dean and Vice President for the Mindanao State University-Iligan Institute of Technology (MSU-IIT), known across the Lanao region as the "Father of IIT." Together, the two formed one of the most consequential intellectual and civic partnerships in Bangsamoro history, placing the rule of law and the power of education side by side as twin pillars of community transformation.

Contents

1 Early Life
2 Education
3 Career
    3.1 Legal Practice
    3.2 Civic and Community Contributions
4 The Boransing Partnership
5 Cultural Significance
6 Faith and Personal Values
7 Legacy and Recognition
8 Notes on Sources and Research Gaps
9 Further Reading
10 See Also

Atty. Lindao Macarambon Boransing



Born	Iligan City, Lanao del Norte, Philippines
Nationality	Filipino
Ethnicity	Maranao
Religion	Islam
Education	Bachelor of Laws (LL.B.)
Bar Admission	1961
Known for	First Maranao woman admitted to the Philippine Bar
Spouse	Prof. Manaros B. Boransing

Early Life

Lindao Macarambon was born and raised in Iligan City, a city that sits at a cultural and geographic crossroads between the predominantly Christian Northern Mindanao and the heartland of the Maranao people along the shores of Lake Lanao. She grew up as part of the Macarambon clan, a family embedded in the social fabric of Maranao society, where lineage, faith, and community standing mattered enormously. The mid-20th century Philippines was a complex place for Muslim women. Prevailing social norms in many Maranao communities still steered young women toward early domestic roles, and the idea of a woman traveling to Manila alone to pursue a law degree was, frankly, not something most families encouraged. That Lindao chose to do exactly that says something meaningful about both her personal determination and the openness of her family to support a different kind of path.

She grew up speaking Maranao and came of age during the Commonwealth and early post-independence era of the Philippines, a time when the Muslim Filipinos of Mindanao were navigating shifting political landscapes while holding fast to their Islamic identity and adat (customary traditions). Her early formation, grounded in that dual

loyalty to faith and civic life, would define the arc of her entire professional career.

Education

Atty. Lindao pursued her legal education in Manila, joining a small but determined cohort of Muslim students who made the journey to the capital in the 1950s for higher studies. The exact institution where she completed her Bachelor of Laws (LL.B.) degree has not been definitively confirmed in available public records, and primary verification through university archives or the Supreme Court Roll of Attorneys is recommended. What is firmly documented, however, is that she successfully hurdled the **1961 Philippine Bar Examinations**, making her the first woman of Maranao heritage to earn admission to the Philippine Bar.<ref name="wiki-asia">Template:Cite web</ref>

Some accounts describe her more broadly as the first Muslim woman in the Philippines to have been admitted to the Bar. While this broader claim is widely cited in oral tradition and community memory across the Lanao region, it has not yet been conclusively verified against primary records such as the Supreme Court Roll of Attorneys for the period. Researchers and those expanding this article are encouraged to consult the Supreme Court's official rolls for 1961 to confirm or refine this scope.<ref name="wiki-asia" />

Passing the bar in 1961 was no small feat for anyone. For a Maranao woman doing it in that era, it was extraordinary, and it did not go unnoticed in the communities of Lanao del Norte and Lanao del Sur.

Career

Legal Practice

After her bar admission, Atty. Lindao returned to her roots in the Iligan-Lanao corridor, where she established herself as a practicing lawyer. Her professional work was characterized by a quiet, principled approach to justice, and she often found herself bridging two different legal frameworks that intersected in the lives of her community: the civil law system of the Philippine Republic, and the Shari'ah-rooted customary norms that governed personal and family matters among Muslims. This was not merely a professional challenge. It required cultural sensitivity, a deep understanding of Islamic jurisprudence, and the kind of trust that only comes from being genuinely embedded in the community you serve.

She was, by most accounts from those who knew her, a practitioner who took cases seriously and who understood that the law was only as meaningful as its application in people's daily lives. Her presence as a female Maranao lawyer gave many families from the region a point of access to the formal legal system that they might not otherwise have sought out.

Civic and Community Contributions

Beyond her legal work, Atty. Lindao was deeply involved in the civic life of Iligan City. She served informally as a legal resource and adviser for community initiatives, organizations, and individuals who needed guidance but could not easily navigate the formal legal system on their own. This kind of behind-the-scenes, sustained public service is often underdocumented but critically important in communities where formal institutions are not always accessible or trusted.

She was also present, alongside her husband, in the early and formative years of MSU-IIT's development. While Prof. Manaros Boransing was the institutional face of that era, Atty. Lindao provided what the source documents describe as "the legal and emotional anchor" for the family's deep involvement in shaping a university that would go on to become one of the country's leading science and technology institutions.<ref name="msuiit-history">Template:Cite web</ref>

The Boransing Partnership

The story of Atty. Lindao is inseparable from that of her husband, Prof. Manaros B. Boransing, though it is important to recognize her as a person of individual distinction, not merely as a spouse.

Prof. Boransing was appointed **Dean of IIT** on July 9, 1973, and later became the **Vice President for MSU-IIT** when the campus was granted autonomous status in 1975 under the Mindanao State University Board of Regents.<ref name="msuiit-history" /><ref name="msuiit-50">Template:Cite web</ref> He served in that capacity until 1988, and is affectionately known throughout the institution as the **Father of IIT**, a moniker that reflects his role in transforming the institution into a financially independent, academically robust campus.<ref name="father-iit">Template:Cite web</ref>

Note: Some accounts, including the source document accompanying this article, describe Prof. Boransing as the "Founding Chancellor" of MSU-IIT. This is inconsistent with official MSU-IIT records, which identify **Dr. Camar A. Umpa** as the first Chancellor of MSU-IIT, having succeeded Boransing in that leadership transition. Researchers should consult the MSU-IIT Board of Regents records to confirm titles and succession.

The home the two built together in Iligan became what their contemporaries describe as a gathering place for intellectual exchange, community deliberation, and civic planning. Atty. Lindao's legal training and Prof. Boransing's educational leadership fed each other. They shared the belief, common to the best minds of their generation in Mindanao, that the so-called "Mindanao problem" could not be solved by arms or politics alone, but required world-class education and the consistent application of the rule of law.

> "Her success was a message to every Maranao girl: The courtrooms and chambers of justice are as much your home as the traditional torogan."

This sentiment, preserved in the oral tradition of those who knew her, captures why her legacy endures not just as a historical footnote but as a living reference point for Bangsamoro women in law, governance, and public life.

Cultural Significance

Atty. Lindao's achievement must be understood in its full cultural context. The Maranao people place enormous social value on family, lineage, and the role of women within the domestic sphere. In many traditional families, a woman pursuing a law degree in Manila in the 1950s would have been seen as an unusual, even transgressive, choice. The fact that Lindao did it, and did it successfully, was a quiet but powerful argument that the traditional Maranao identity and modern professional life were not in conflict.

She demonstrated that a devout Muslim woman could sit for and pass one of the most rigorous national examinations in the Philippines, earn the respect of the formal legal system, and still remain rooted in the culture and community that raised her. She did not migrate to Manila or transform into a Manila-based professional. She came home, and she served.

For the Bangsamoro women who came after her, whether in law, medicine, education, government, or the arts, Atty. Lindao is part of the foundation. She belongs in the same conversation as other pioneering Bangsamoro women like Tarhata Alonto-Lucman, the first woman governor of Lanao del Sur, as figures who showed what was possible when a Maranao woman was given, or claimed for herself, the space to lead.

Faith and Personal Values

Atty. Lindao's Islamic faith was central to how she understood her role as a lawyer and as a public figure. For her, the pursuit of justice was not simply a professional obligation but a moral and spiritual one. Islam places the concept of 'adl, or justice, among its highest values, and that framework appears to have shaped both the cases she chose to take and the manner in which she practiced.

Her commitment to her roots, to remaining in the Lanao region rather than chasing higher status or more lucrative work in major urban centers, also reflects a set of personal values consistent with Islamic notions of community responsibility and service. She didn't practice law for recognition. She practiced it because the people around her needed what she could offer.

Legacy and Recognition

Atty. Lindao Macarambon Boransing is formally recognized in the **Wikipedia List of First Women Lawyers and Judges in Asia** as the **first female Maranao lawyer**, alongside other pioneering women who broke legal barriers across the continent.<ref name="wiki-asia" />

Her legacy lives on in multiple ways. Every Maranao woman who has passed the bar since 1961 has, in some sense, walked through a door she opened. Every family in the Lanao region that has ever sought legal advice from a Muslim woman lawyer has benefited, even if unknowingly, from the credibility she established for that kind of professional relationship.

The MSU-IIT community, whose founding she witnessed and quietly shaped alongside her husband, also carries traces of her influence. The institution she helped anchor in its early years has gone on to become a Centre of Excellence in Science and Technology, one of the Philippines' premier higher education institutions, and one of the few in Mindanao to break into international university rankings.<ref name="msuiit-history" />

Her story, however, is still incompletely documented. Much of what is known about her comes from oral histories, community memory, and the records associated with her husband's career. A dedicated effort to recover her individual story, through interviews with surviving contemporaries, family members, archival research at the Supreme Court, and documentation from Iligan City's civic history, would be a meaningful contribution to Bangsamoro women's history.

Notes on Sources and Research Gaps

The following source pathways are recommended for those seeking to expand or verify this article:

- **Supreme Court Roll of Attorneys (1961)**: The official record for confirming her bar admission year, roll number, and the scope of her "first" designation among Muslim women.
- **MSU-IIT Archives**: Records from the 1973 to 1988 period of Prof. Boransing's leadership may contain references to Atty. Lindao's legal and advisory roles.
- **Oral Histories of Iligan City**: Community elders and historians in Iligan and the Lanao region maintain accounts of her presence and influence. These should be recorded and preserved systematically.

- **National Commission on Muslim Filipinos (NCMF) Archives**: May contain biographical or reference materials related to pioneering Bangsamoro professionals.
- **Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) Historical Records**: May document her as part of broader narratives on Bangsamoro women in law and public service.

Further Reading

- Boransing, Manaros B. *The MSU-IIT Story: Memoirs of Manaros B. Boransing*. Manuscript on file, Department of History, College of Arts and Social Sciences, MSU-IIT, Iligan City, 2016.
- "'Father of IIT' Boransing Finishes Manuscript of His IIT Memoirs." MSU-IIT Office of Publication and Information. April 19, 2016. https://www.msuiit.edu.ph/news/news-detail.php?id=808
- "List of First Women Lawyers and Judges in Asia." Wikipedia. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_first_women_lawyers_and_judges_in_Asia
- "The MSU-IIT History." MSU-IIT 54th Charter Day. https://sites.google.com/g.msuiit.edu.ph/54thcharterday/iit-history

See Also

- Maranao people
- Manaros Boransing
- Mindanao State University - Iligan Institute of Technology
- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Tarhata Alonto-Lucman
- Iligan City
- Women in Islam
- Bangsamoro women in public service

Editorial Notice: BangsamoroPedia is a curated knowledge archive. Its pages are maintained by the editorial administrator to help ensure historical accuracy. If you would like to suggest corrections, share sources, or contribute information, please message the administrator through the official Facebook page: **Notable Muslim Filipinos**.

Retrieved from "https://wiki.maranaw.com/index.php?title=Lindao_Macarambon_Boransing&oldid=3089"